

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Pentecost 8
Another Kind of Freedom ~ Truth Telling
26 July 2026

COMMUNION
NEO Voice Festival Choir

Michael away

Preaching: LVF
Worship Leading: Rev. Chad Tanaka Pack & Meg Russett

Organ Prelude-Concert

Improvisation

Sandra ?, Cathedral Choir Member

Everything is Immanent – Jason Olshan

Air – Saginaw Rozzo

Dr. Abraham Ross, *Guest Organist*

Alleluyas – Simon Preston

Sienna Stribling, *2026 N.E.O. Organ Fellow*

Chiming of the Hour

[Chad and Meg to center chancel]

Welcome

CTP

Words of Gathering

MR & CTP

MR: As we greet this new day, let us gather our courage.

CTP: We can do hard things

Brave things

Beautiful things

Risky and transformative things

MR: The Sacred journeys with us
toward freedom
For the sake of the collective life
For the sake of disrupting evil
For the sake of the human soul

CTP: We are called and accompanied.
never really alone

MR: This morning,
May our hearts be encouraged
[adpt/enfleshedmjadekaiser]

MR: *Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering*

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn Of Gathering**

[Chad center chancel]

Prayer of Awareness

CTP

[All turn towards choir]

Introit

“Analogy of Being” part III
N.E.O. Festival Choir and Cathedral Choir

Fahad Siadat

[Meg to lectern]

***The Lord’s Prayer**

MR

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Chad center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace**

CTP

Please join me in these words of peace:

And also with you.

You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow

Please be seated

[Meg to lectern]

Reading from Our Religious Tradition
Amos 5:24

from the Prophet Amos

MR

"But let justice roll on like a river, righteousness like a never-failing stream!"

Thanks be to God!

[Christoph transition Chad to center chancel]

Prayers with the People

CTP

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

[2 minutes Christoph transition out of silence]

Prayer of Our Hearts

Amen and Amen.

[Christoph transition for choir]

Meditation Anthem

"There Is Light"

Clara Moniz

N.E.O. Festival Choir and Cathedral Choir

"There is silence now where there once was colour There is light In place of fear There is space where life was full and love replacing emptiness Hollow space overflowing The overflow and the flood Overflowing Love" ~Clara Moniz

[Christoph transition Laura to pulpit]

Sermon

Truth Telling

LVF

[Christoph transition as Chad & Laura go behind communion table]

The Eucharist and Blessings

LVF & CTP

Words of Invitation and Remembrance

Prayer of Blessing

Amen and Amen.

LVF: This table is for all, whether you have a lot of faith, etc....

Sharing of the Bread and the Cup

At this table we celebrate all the diverse ways we have been created. Everyone is invited to share in this feast. This morning we will receive communion with gluten free wafers and grape juice. You are invited to come forward to receive these gifts and then light a candle to signify the prayers of your heart on this day. As we share this time, we remember that this is the bread of new life and the cup of hope, given in love for each of us.

[Meg to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity

MR

Offertory

“I’ve Learned To Sing”

Sam Scheibe

N.E.O. Festival Choir and Cathedral Choir

*“I’ve learned to sing a song of hope, I’ve said goodbye to despair,
I caught the note in a thrush’s throat, I sang---and the world was fair!*

I’ve learned to sing a song of joy It bends the skies to me,

The song of joy is the song of hope Grown to maturity.

I’ve learned to laugh away my tears As through the dark I go

For love and laughter conquer fears My heart has come to know.

I’ve learned a song of happiness It is a song of love For love alone is happiness

And happiness is love.” ~Georgia Douglass Johnson

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator’s praise arise!

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[Meg to lectern]

***Prayer of Offering**

MR

*May it ever be so for all of us.
Amen and Amen.*

Please be seated

[Laura center chancel]

Life at First Church

LVF

Words of Blessing

LVF

Choral Response “Ka Sise Fun Iwenumo Emi Wa” Yoruba hymn, arr. Damilola Odebiyi
N.E.O. Festival Choir and Cathedral Choir

*“In vanity we hope after worldly promises that vanish. Let us join together to bring about the
beloved community of the divine. God has promised the fruits of these labors. Amen!”*

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Chad center chancel to say: please be seated for the postlude]

Postlude

Improvisation

Dr. Abraham Ross, *Guest Organist*

Inside The Music

